MigrationNarrate: A Dataset for Detection of Migration Narratives in YouTube Videos

Fatima Haouari, Carolina Scarton, Kalina Bontcheva
Department of Computer Science, University of Sheffield, UK
{f.haouari,c.scarton,k.bontcheva}@sheffield.ac.uk

Abstract

Narratives are central to how social communication is framed, making their detection critical for understanding and analysing public discourse. Prior work has explored narrative detection and extraction across diverse domains; however, migration narratives remain significantly understudied, primarily due to the absence of dedicated annotated datasets. Furthermore, public communication has recently shifted towards video-centric platforms, where narratives are conveyed through multimodal signals and consumed at scale. Despite this shift, narratives in videos remain largely unexplored. To bridge these gaps, we introduce **MigrationNarrate**, the first multimodal dataset for detection of migration narratives in the UK, consisting of 1,115 YouTube video transcripts annotated using a two-level taxonomy of 12 migration super-narratives and 53 narrative labels. This paper details the dataset design, collection, and annotations, together with benchmark results using a combination of pre-trained encoder models and both open- and closed-source Large Language Models. Finally, a thorough error analysis offers insights for future work.

1 Introduction

Video has become a dominant form of content consumption. As of March 2026, YouTube reaches over 2.83 billion users worldwide, with approximately 340 million daily users and more than 1.8 million hours of videos uploaded daily (Resourcera, 2026). This scale underscores the increasing influence of video-based media in shaping information exposure and public discourse, allowing narratives to be delivered at scale, potentially amplifying the spread of misleading or biased content. Despite a growing body of research on narrative detection and extraction, existing work has predominantly focused on textual data from social media platforms such as X (Ai et al., 2024; Fraile-Hernández et al., 2024; Haouari et al., 2025) and Facebook (Rowlands et al., 2024) and from news articles (Coan et al., 2021; Piskorski et al., 2022; Nikolaidis et al., 2025; Guimarães et al., 2025). Detecting narratives in video transcripts remains largely understudied, despite its importance since videos differ from written text in structure and delivery (Dingemanse and Liesenfeld, 2022). Qualitative work has nevertheless shown that YouTube provides an important space for migration-related storytelling, including the construction of family histories and migration experiences (Düzcan, 2025). Additionally, although previous work has focused on diverse domains, such as COVID-19 (Kotseva et al., 2023; Heinrich et al., 2024), elections (Haouari et al., 2025), climate change (Coan et al., 2021; Piskorski et al., 2022; Nikolaidis et al., 2025), and the Ukraine-Russia war (Ai et al., 2024; Nikolaidis et al., 2025), migration narratives are yet to be studied. *Migration narratives* are defined by Seiger et al. (2025) as "the stories, ideas and perceptions that people have about migration and migrants. These narratives can be influenced by various factors such as media, politics and social interactions. They can shape public opinion and policy decisions". While migration narratives can emphasise solidarity and humanitarian perspectives, migration-related discourse often contains polarised and negative framings that contribute to the spread of misconceptions and exclusionary at-



Figure 1: Example from **MigrationNarrate** dataset.

Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing, pages 47624–47645
October 24-29, 2026 ©2026 Association for Computational Linguistics

titudes (Seiger et al., 2025). This underscores the importance of detecting migration narratives for understanding and analysing public discourse.

In this work, we take the first step towards addressing this gap by introducing **MigrationNarrate**, a novel dataset for migration narrative detection in videos (example in Figure 1). The dataset comprises 1,115 video transcripts annotated using a migration narrative taxonomy introduced by the European Commission's Joint Research Centre (JRC) (Seiger et al., 2025). The taxonomy categorises European migration-related discourse into a set of recurrent narrative framings of **12 super-narratives and 53 narratives**, covering narratives that frame migration in humanitarian and solidarity-based terms, as well as narratives emphasising exclusion, policy regulation, or security concerns. To summarise, our contributions are as follows:

- **MigrationNarrate**, the first dataset for detecting UK-related migration narratives in video transcripts, consisting of 1,115 annotated YouTube video transcripts using a two-level taxonomy of super-narratives and narratives. We also release 4,425 automatically filtered, unlabelled migration-related videos.[1]
- Benchmarking pre-trained encoder models and both open- and closed-source Large Language Models (LLMs) on **MigrationNarrate**.
- An extensive error analysis providing insights for future research.

2 Related Work

Migration Narratives Research on migration narratives has explored political and media contexts both conceptually and empirically (Şahin-Mencütek, 2020; Maneri et al., 2023). Prior work has investigated their roles in policymaking and public discourse (Dennison, 2021), while other studies have mapped their distribution across media platforms and countries, highlighting the influence of context, event type, and media genre (Maneri et al., 2023). Additional work explores the factors driving narrative influence and success (Dennison, 2021; Garcés-Mascareñas and Pastore, 2025), as well as their circulation between media and political actors (Smellie and Boswell, 2025). Policy-oriented research further provides a comprehensive overview of migration narratives and their impact on public perception and policy, defining migration narratives and introducing a hierarchical taxonomy of super-narratives and narrative categories (Seiger et al., 2025). Qualitative work has also examined migration-related storytelling on YouTube. For example, Düzcan (2025) analyses how Turkish migrant families use YouTube to construct and mediatise family histories, migration experiences, identity, and belonging. Recently, Ghafouri et al. (2025) analysed migration discourse in UK parliamentary debates and US congressional speech using open-source LLMs for stance annotation and narrative frame extraction, enabling the analysis of migration framing across time and political parties. However, they did not release a publicly annotated dataset.

Narrative Detection As summarised in Table 1, prior work on narrative detection has examined a range of topics, including climate change (Coan et al., 2021; Piskorski et al., 2022; Rowlands et al., 2024; Nikolaidis et al., 2025; Guimarães et al., 2025), the Ukraine war (Ai et al., 2024; Nikolaidis et al., 2025; Guimarães et al., 2025), COVID-19 (Kotseva et al., 2023; Heinrich et al., 2024; Fraile-Hernández et al., 2024), and elections (Haouari et al., 2025). These studies analyse narratives across different platforms, primarily using social media such X (Ai et al., 2024; Haouari et al., 2025), and Facebook (Rowlands et al., 2024), and news articles (Coan et al., 2021; Nikolaidis et al., 2025; Guimarães et al., 2025) as data sources. However, to the best of our knowledge, there is no dataset specifically designed for the detection of migration narratives in video transcripts. To address this gap, we introduce **MigrationNarrate**, the first dataset of migration narratives in videos.

3 The MigrationNarrate Dataset

In this section, we present the migration narratives taxonomy adopted in our study (Sec 3.1), our approach to collecting videos (Sec 3.2), the process of filtering migration-related videos (Sec 3.3), and the annotation procedure (Sec 3.4).

3.1 Migration Narratives Taxonomy

In this work, we adopt the migration narrative taxonomy introduced by the JRC (Seiger et al., 2025). We selected this taxonomy because it is a recent, migration-specific framework developed for the European context, which closely aligns with the geographical scope of our data. This taxonomy categorises European migration-related discourse into a set of recurrent narrative framings, drawing on a comprehensive review of scientific literature,

[1] https://github.com/GateNLP/MigrationNarrate

Dataset	Source	Topic	Lang	# Narratives	# Instances
CARDS (Coan et al., 2021)	Articles	Climate Change	En	5/27	28,945
Climate (Piskorski et al., 2022)	Articles	Climate Change	En	5/27	1,118
COVID-19 (Kotseva et al., 2023)	Articles	COVID-19	En	12/51	58,625
COVID-19-Ger (Heinrich et al., 2024)	Telegram	COVID-19	De	14	1,099
DIPROMATS (Fraile-Hernández et al., 2024)	Twitter	Narratives around COVID-19 by Authorities	En/Es	4/24	1,272,272
TweetIntent@Crisis (Ai et al., 2024)	Twitter	Ukraine-Russia War	En	2	3,691
Climate_ads (Rowlands et al., 2024)	Facebook	Climate Change in US ads	En	7	1,330
PolyNarrative (Nikolaidis et al., 2025)	Articles	Ukraine-Russia War//Climate Change	Multi	11/38//10/36	2,467
NarratEX (Guimarães et al., 2025)	Articles	Ukraine-Russia War//Climate Change	Multi	11/38//10/36	1,056
UKElectionNarratives (Haouari et al., 2025)	Twitter	UK Elections 2019/2024	En	10/32	2,000
MigrationNarrate	YouTube	Migration Crisis in UK	En	12/51	1,115

Table 1: Comparison of **MigrationNarrate** with existing public datasets for detecting narratives. # Narratives is presented as # Super-narratives/# Narratives for datasets with two-level annotation scheme.

expert studies, and data analysis, as well as expertise from the JRC, the European Policy Centre, and the European University Institute. It comprises **12 super-narratives and 53 narratives**, covering narratives that frame migration in humanitarian and solidarity-based terms, as well as narratives emphasising exclusion, policy regulation, or security concerns. Its hierarchical structure, combining broad super-narratives with fine-grained narratives, provides an appropriate framework for systematic annotation of migration narratives in our data.

The JRC taxonomy provides expert-defined super-narratives and their associated fine-grained narratives. Although it does not provide standalone definitions for the fine-grained narratives, their meanings are described within the corresponding super-narrative definitions. To support annotation, we prompted GPT-5.1 (Singh et al., 2025a) to formulate concise narrative definitions grounded in the corresponding JRC super-narrative definitions, which were subsequently manually reviewed and validated by the authors to ensure consistency with the original taxonomy (see Appendix A for the full set of narrative definitions).

3.2 YouTube Videos Collection

To collect videos *potentially* discussing the migration crisis in the UK, we adopted two approaches:

Channel- and Playlist-Based Video Collection We collected YouTube videos using the YouTube Data API v3,[2] targeting both channels whose content is primarily centred on migration discourse and channels with a broader editorial scope where migration-related discussions frequently appear. We selected channels to reflect influential sources in the UK from multiple perspectives, including institutional media outlets (e.g., BBC News and GB News), political actors such as political parties and government channels (e.g., Labour Party and Reform UK), as well as prominent non-institutional commentators, activists, and independent accounts that regularly engage in migration-related debates (e.g., @TommyRobinsonOnline and @drmatthewgoodwin). For channels focused on political actors or organisations, such as political parties, we collected all available videos uploaded to their channels. For channels with more heterogeneous content, such as news agencies, we collected videos selectively by targeting specific playlists. Playlist selection included both explicitly migration-focused playlists (e.g., *Migration Crisis* on Sky News and *Immigration* on TalkTV) and broader political playlists where migration-related content may also appear (e.g., *UK Politics* on Channel 4 News). Overall, videos were collected from 25 playlists and 21 unique channels. The full list of channels and playlists is presented in Appendix B.

Search-Based Video Collection In addition to collecting videos from channels and playlists, we employed a complementary search-based retrieval strategy to capture migration-related content produced by a broader and more diverse set of users. This approach aimed to identify videos containing migration narratives beyond institutional, political, or media-affiliated sources. We used the YouTube Search API[3] to retrieve videos using a set of general and narrative-oriented search phrases. The initial set of **general search phrases** was constructed based on domain knowledge and commonly used terms in public discussions of migration in the UK. To improve coverage and diversify the query space, **narrative-oriented search phrases** were constructed to retrieve videos that potentially express these narratives, and subsequently refined

[2] https://developers.google.com/youtube/v3

[3] https://developers.google.com/youtube/v3/docs/search/list

through multiple rounds of manual review. In total, **77 search phrases** were used (listed in Appendix C) including **15 general phrases** such as *Channel crossings UK*, and *Stop the boats UK*, as well as **62 narrative-oriented phrases** such as *immigration housing crisis UK* and *immigrants taking jobs UK*, which correspond to the *Immigration burdens the economy & welfare* super-narrative.

3.3 Filtering Migration Videos

Given that annotation is costly and time-consuming, particularly in the context of large-scale and diverse migration narratives, we employ a multi-step filtering pipeline. By removing videos that are unlikely to contain migration narratives, cost and annotators' time and effort are significantly reduced.

Metadata-based filtering We downloaded the collected videos using *yt-dlp*, an open-source tool for video downloading from YouTube.[4] Only videos with a duration of *three minutes or less* and published between *1 January 2024 and 30 September 2025* were retained, focusing the dataset on short-form content. After downloading the videos, we generated the video transcripts using *faster-whisper* (Radford et al., 2023), an efficient implementation of the Whisper automatic speech recognition model.[5] Videos without successfully generated transcripts were excluded. In addition, a subset of videos retrieved via the YouTube Search API (particularly those published in 2024) were no longer accessible at the time of download, despite having retrievable metadata. These cases corresponded to videos that had been removed or whose channels were no longer available. This filtering step resulted in a total of 20,992 videos.

Semantic filtering To identify UK migration-relevant content, we filtered video transcripts using embedding-based semantic similarity. Migration relevance was estimated using the E5-Large model (Wang et al., 2022)[6] by comparing transcript embeddings against a fixed set of ten immigration-related queries (queries are presented in Appendix D). For each transcript, cosine similarity was computed with each query, and the maximum similarity score was taken as the immigration score. The query set was designed to capture broad and commonly occurring formulations of migration-related discourse in the UK context. Queries were expressed using general, high-level language rather than specific slogans or claims, with examples including *"immigration in the UK"* and *"asylum seekers in the UK"*. Transcripts with an immigration score of 0.8 or higher were retained for subsequent analysis.[7] In total, 5,540 videos were selected at this stage.

A diverse sample for human annotation In order to pre-select a balanced subset of videos across super-narratives and narratives for subsequent human annotation (Ai et al., 2024; Haouari et al., 2025), we used GPT-5.1 for preliminary annotation. Given a video transcript and the migration narrative taxonomy, the model was prompted to identify the dominant super-narrative and narrative expressed in the video. It was also instructed to return a confidence score for its prediction, with *None* assigned when no migration narrative was explicitly stated or strongly implied. Videos with a main narrative confidence score of at least 0.8 were selected, and videos assigned the *None* label were excluded. These preliminary labels were used only to guide sample selection; the selected videos were subsequently annotated independently by human annotators. For each narrative category, if the number of eligible videos was 40 or fewer, all such videos were retained. When a narrative contained more than 40 eligible videos, 40 videos were sampled using a round-robin strategy designed to promote diversity across publication year (2024 vs. 2025) and channel title, ensuring balanced temporal coverage and limiting over-representation from individual channels. A total of **1,115 videos** were selected for human annotation.

3.4 Annotation Management

Given the complexity of the annotation task, we did not rely on crowdsourcing; instead, we recruited a pool of student annotators. Following the training and qualification process, six annotators were retained for the main annotation phase. They were final-year undergraduate or postgraduate students majoring in international relations and politics, all highly proficient in English. We compensated the annotators at a rate of 17.58 GBP per hour, and we conducted the annotation using the collaborative web-based annotation tool Teamware (Wilby et al.,

[4] https://github.com/yt-dlp/yt-dlp
[5] https://github.com/SYSTRAN/faster-whisper
[6] https://huggingface.co/intfloat/e5-large-v2

[7] This threshold was selected based on a manual inspection of a representative sample, balancing coverage and precision.

2023).[8] The annotation process was as follows:

Pilot study Before commencing the official annotation, we conducted a pilot study with two recruited students, both with prior experience in annotating political narratives. The pilot study helped identify key challenges annotators might face and informed refinements to the annotation guidelines, task setup, and training. Among the videos annotated during the pilot study, we retained 30 for which the two annotators independently assigned the same label to construct the gold-standard set. These agreed cases were subsequently reviewed by one of the authors with experience in narrative analysis and detection to validate the assigned labels, and were used for quality control.

Annotator training Following the pilot study, all potential annotators were invited to a training session to introduce them to the project. This session covered the annotation guidelines, included illustrative examples, and provided an opportunity for questions and discussion to ensure a shared understanding of the task. After training, annotators labelled the gold set, and only those who achieved a Cohen's kappa (Cohen, 1960) of at least 0.45 on super-narratives and 0.35 on narratives were selected for the main annotation phase. These thresholds were selected based on our pilot study, as well as prior work showing that only fair to moderate agreement is typically achieved during the early stages of annotating fine-grained labels (Salman et al., 2023; Haouari et al., 2025).

Data annotation We adopted a batch-based annotation scheme (Maarouf et al., 2024; Haouari et al., 2025), partitioning the data into 11 batches. For each batch, two annotators were randomly selected from the pool of six and independently annotated the videos. Disagreement cases were then resolved by a third annotator, who served as the adjudicator and determined the final label, following established practices in narrative annotation (Nikolaidis et al., 2025; Piskorski et al., 2025). Annotators were provided with the video transcript and a direct link to the video (see Figure 2 in Appendix E). To reduce cognitive load caused by the large number of narrative labels (53 labels), annotators were initially shown only the list of super-narratives (12 labels), while the full list of individual narratives was hidden. Once a super-narrative was selected, the corresponding set of narratives was displayed, allowing annotators to choose the most appropriate label while reducing confusion and improving annotation consistency. Definitions of all super-narratives and individual narratives were provided to annotators. During annotation, these definitions were accessible by hovering over each label on the annotation framework, allowing annotators to quickly review the intended meaning of a narrative. Additionally, a separate document containing the full set of definitions was shared during training so that annotators could review the taxonomy before the annotation session.

Data quality Inter-annotator agreement, measured using Cohen's kappa before adjudication, was 0.45 at the super-narrative level and 0.30 at the narrative level, indicating moderate and fair agreement, respectively. These agreement levels are modest but expected given the task's complexity and fine-grained labels (Nikolaidis et al., 2025; Piskorski et al., 2025; Haouari et al., 2025). Disagreement cases were resolved through a final adjudication step conducted by either one of the most experienced annotators or an author with expertise in political narrative annotation.

3.5 Data Statistics

The resulting **MigrationNarrate** dataset consists of 1,115 human-annotated videos collected from 684 unique YouTube channels, as summarised in Table 7 (Appendix G). These videos represent a manually selected and carefully annotated subset of a substantially larger corpus that was automatically filtered using our multi-step filtering pipeline presented in Section 3.3. In addition to the human-annotated set, **we release the larger filtered corpus** which can support weak and semi-supervised learning, enabling scalable narrative classification beyond fully supervised settings (Chen et al., 2024; Yang et al., 2025b). Moreover, the filtered corpus can be manually annotated to expand our dataset.

Table 2 presents the distribution of super-narratives and individual narratives in **MigrationNarrate**. The most prevalent super-narrative is *Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative*, with 190 videos, while the most frequent individual narrative is *Political rivals' policy failed/ is failing/ will fail* (under the *It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)* super-narrative), with 65 videos. Additionally, similar to existing datasets with fine-grained narrative labels (Haouari et al., 2025; Niko-

[8] https://gatenlp.github.io/gate-teamware/development/

laidis et al., 2025; Piskorski et al., 2025), the class distribution is imbalanced. Two of the 53 narratives in the taxonomy (Immigrants spread diseases and Vindication) do not occur in the annotated data, so 51 narratives are represented in MigrationNarrate. Table 9 in Appendix H shows examples from **MigrationNarrate**.

Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative	**190**
Immigrants do not contribute to the economy	25
Immigrants take our jobs	10
Many asylum seekers are actually economic migrants	21
Natives loose to immigrants/Immigrants receive better benefits than nationals	32
Receiving immigrants is too expensive/immigration burdens tax payers	32
Immigrants abuse the welfare system	16
Immigrants are a strain on the housing market	33
Immigrants are a strain on our health-care system	5
Immigration reduces the attractiveness of location and lowers overall life quality	6
Natives first	10
It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)	**177**
Political rivals' policy failed/ is failing/ will fail	65
Political rivals act against the interests of the people	39
Discrediting liberal values	2
Discrediting political rivals (e.g. ridicule, accusation)	42
Let's overthrow the establishment	7
EU is harmful for our nation	4
Our sovereignty is under threat	1
Anti-Elitism	17
Immigrants are victims	**115**
Immigrants are victims of false hope	12
Immigrants are victims of human traffickers	30
EU/MS do not have the means to properly take care of immigrants	3
Certain immigrants/asylum seekers are discriminated against	34
MS or EU are in breach of international law	12
Immigrants suffer from labour exploitation	24
Immigration is a threat	**111**
Immigration is a threat to individual safety	26
Immigration is a threat to national security	21
Immigrants are prone to committing crimes (violent, non-violent, or organised)	22
Immigrants are prone to committing crimes of a sexual nature	29
Many immigrants are terrorists	13
Immigrants' identity and/or culture is problematic	**104**
Immigration is a threat to the European way of life/identity	27
Arabs and/or Muslims are a cultural/social threat	38
Certain immigrants are unwilling/incapable to integrate	39
We are competent	**90**
Promoting policy initiatives or ideas	53
Applauding political allies	4
We represent the people	7
We stand for common sense	6
We will reinstate order	20
Immigration is out of control	**82**
There are too many immigrants coming	48
Our borders are strained and/or insufficiently controlled	34
There is an unfair bias against our political camp	**43**
We are being silenced	25
Mainstream media are biased	5
There are double-standards/the system is corrupt	11
The judicial system favours political rivals and/or obstructs own political camp	2
Pragmatic approaches to immigration	**43**
Immigration helps tackle social & economic issues	43
Immigration is part of a conspiracy	**33**
Blaming global elites	11
Great replacement	17
Other conspiracy theory	5
Narrative strategy to remain in the news	**11**
Reminder that immigration is an issue	5
Self-promotion	6
Geopolitical narratives: Countries are acting against the interest of other countries	**10**
Immigration is abused as a political tool	2
Our country is doing more than other countries to deal with immigration issues	8
None	106
Total	**1,115**

Table 2: **MigrationNarrate** super-narratives (in bold) and narratives statistics.

4 Experiments and Evaluation

To establish baselines for the **MigrationNarrate** dataset, we benchmarked different model configurations across three dimensions: *(1) pre-trained encoder-based models versus LLMs*, *(2) prompting-based inference versus supervised fine-tuning*, and *(3) open-source versus closed-source models*. Our experiments rely exclusively on video transcripts, providing a strong text-based baseline for the task. More advanced approaches that incorporate additional modalities, such as visual and audio signals, remain an important direction for future work.

4.1 Experimental setup

Model Selection We experimented with the following set of models:

1. **Pre-trained encoder-based models**: we fine-tuned RoBERTa-large (Liu et al., 2019) for two classification tasks: (1) a model that predicts the higher-level super-narratives; (2) a model that predicts the fine-grained narratives.
2. **Open-source LLMs**: we evaluated Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct (Grattafiori et al., 2024), Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct (Yang et al., 2025a), and Gemma-3-12b-it (Kamath et al., 2025) under *zero-shot*, *few-shot*, and *fine-tuning* settings.
3. **Closed-source LLMs**: we prompted GPT-4o (Hurst et al., 2024) and GPT-5.4 (OpenAI, 2026) under *zero-shot* and *few-shot* settings.

Prompting setup For all LLMs, we adopted a two-step hierarchical prompting approach (Singh et al., 2025b) in which the models were first asked to identify the super-narrative and then to detect the corresponding narrative. This setup mirrors the annotation procedure provided to annotators and helps avoid confusing the models with a long list of narratives. For both the *zero-shot* and *few-shot* settings, the label definitions were provided to the models. In the *few-shot* setting, the models were additionally given one example for each class. Our prompts are presented in Appendix F.

Fine-tuning setup We apply standard supervised fine-tuning to RoBERTa-large, while the three LLMs are adapted using Quantized Low-Rank Adaptation (QLoRA) (Dettmers et al., 2023). Training settings and hyperparameters for all models are given in Appendices I and J.

Data splits To create the data splits, we used stratified sampling (Sechidis et al., 2011), allocat-

Model	Setting	Super-narratives			Narratives		
		Macro-F1	Macro-Prec	Macro-Recall	Macro-F1	Macro-Prec	Macro-Recall
RoBERTa-large	fine-tuned	0.446	0.445	0.458	0.212	0.223	0.234
Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct	zero-shot	0.226	0.307	0.224	0.130	0.203	0.132
	few-shot	0.115	0.296	0.132	0.028	0.055	0.041
	fine-tuned	**0.525**	0.543	**0.525**	0.304	0.309	0.340
Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct	zero-shot	0.246	0.315	0.272	0.107	0.137	0.114
	few-shot	0.316	0.350	0.329	0.160	0.188	0.182
	fine-tuned	0.434	0.472	0.449	0.249	0.261	0.278
Gemma-3-12b-it	zero-shot	0.378	0.552	0.395	0.227	0.278	0.254
	few-shot	0.423	0.414	0.467	0.228	0.235	0.267
	fine-tuned	0.502	0.512	0.521	0.282	0.287	0.304
GPT-4o	zero-shot	0.427	0.500	0.455	0.305	**0.346**	0.353
	few-shot	0.440	0.460	0.509	**0.350**	0.341	**0.403**
GPT-5.4	zero-shot	0.466	**0.558**	0.472	0.316	0.341	0.380
	few-shot	0.480	0.503	0.502	0.324	0.323	0.373

Table 3: Performance of the models on the **test set**. The best score for each evaluation measure is shown in bold, and the second-best score is underlined.

ing 70% of the data for training, 10% for development, and 20% for testing. Specifically, we used 774, 117 and 224 videos as train, dev, and test data, respectively. For extremely low-frequency narrative classes containing only one or two instances (four narratives in total), these examples were excluded from the training split and retained only for evaluation.

4.2 Results and Discussion

Pre-trained encoders vs. LLMs: As shown in Table 3, for **super-narrative classification** the fine-tuned RoBERTa model achieved results close to GPT-4o, slightly surpassing it in the *few-shot* setting, and outperformed all open-source LLMs under both *zero-shot* and *few-shot* settings. However, it remained below GPT-5.4, which achieved a Macro-F1 of 0.480 compared to 0.446 for RoBERTa. Fine-tuning substantially improved the performance of Gemma and Llama, which surpassed RoBERTa with Macro-F1 scores of 0.502 and 0.525, respectively. However, the fine-tuned Qwen remained below the encoder-based baseline. At the **narrative level**, both Qwen and Llama underperformed compared to RoBERTa in the *zero-shot* and *few-shot* settings, whereas Gemma and GPT models outperformed RoBERTa. After *fine-tuning*, all open-source LLMs consistently outperformed RoBERTa for fine-grained narrative detection, demonstrating that LLMs benefit substantially more from task-specific adaptation than from prompting alone for this task.

Prompting vs. fine-tuning LLMs: Prompting with *few-shot* examples consistently improved performance over the *zero-shot* setting for both super-narrative and narrative classification across almost all open- and closed-source models. The only exception was Llama, whose performance declined when examples were introduced, suggesting that it may be more sensitive to prompt formulation or example selection. Finally, fine-tuning all open-source LLMs led to substantial performance gains compared to prompting alone, confirming that task-specific adaptation is significantly more effective than *zero-shot* or *few-shot* prompting for this task.

Open- vs. closed-source: For **super-narrative classification**, both GPT-4o and GPT-5.4 outperformed all open-source LLMs in *zero-shot* and *few-shot* settings. Notably, even in the *zero-shot* setting, the closed-source models achieved higher Macro-F1 than open-source LLMs with *few-shot* prompting, highlighting their superior instruction-following capabilities. However, after fine-tuning, Llama achieved the best overall performance for **super-narrative classification**, with a Macro-F1 of 0.525 compared to the best results for GPT-4o (0.440) and GPT-5.4 (0.480), while Gemma also outperformed the closed-source models achieving a Macro-F1 of 0.502. For **narrative classification**, however, even fine-tuned open-source LLMs were unable to surpass the closed-source models. GPT-4o and GPT-5.4 achieved the best results, with Macro-F1 scores of 0.350 and 0.324, respectively, while the two strongest open-source models, Llama and Gemma, reached Macro-F1 scores of 0.304 and 0.282, respectively. These findings suggest that fine-grained narrative detection remains particularly challenging for open-source models, even

Error Type / Explanation	Video transcript	Gold Label	Model Predictions
Surface-Narrative Misalignment (49.7%). The model predicts a narrative aligned with salient topical cues rather than the transcript's dominant narrative, failing to identify the speaker's primary argumentative focus.	"On Saturday this week, a record 973 illegal migrants entered Britain on 17 boats. That is the biggest number this year. And it's yet more evidence, as **I've long been arguing, for why Labour's plan for smashing the gangs isn't going to work. With no active deterrent, with no Rwanda-style plan, with no serious approach to dissuading people from crossing the Channel, with a massive backlog in the asylum system and a pro-immigration government, this crisis on the border is going to get worse and worse and worse.**"	Political rivals' policy failed/ is failing/ will fail	**G:** There are too many immigrants coming **L:** Our borders are strained and/or insufficiently controlled
Fine-Grained Label Confusion (26.67%). The model predicts a semantically related but incorrect narrative label, failing to distinguish between closely related categories and misidentifying the dominant narrative.	**"British citizens are working hard, paying taxes and yet they can't even afford a home.** But the same basically is given free to the illegal migrants who are entering into the country from the day one. I mean they are given forced-fire hotel facilities, NHS facilities, dentist facilities, refugees loans and what not. **All paid by the basically hardworking taxpayer and it has not changed basically from the last successive governments. The situation is getting actually from bad to worse. And there is also basically a growing sense of frustration among the people who feels that the government is actually ignoring them. I think government really need to think about it that the hardworking people paying taxes can't afford the facilities and they have been given free to the people who are coming from other countries without contributing anything.**"	Receiving immigrants is too expensive/ immigration burdens tax payers	**G:** Natives loose to immigrants / Immigrants receive better benefits than nationals **L:** Natives loose to immigrants / Immigrants receive better benefits than nationals
Multi-Narrative Overlap (12.28%). The transcript contains multiple strong narratives, making more than one label plausible depending on which is treated as dominant; the ambiguity arises from the transcript itself rather than a clear model error.	"The Daily Telegraph, one of the best in the MSM, at least had the grace to feature the brave women of Essex on its front page today. [...] **All Yvette Cooper and the Home Office are doing, stop polluting our country. We don't just want illegals moved. We want them out.** And what happened in Epping last night was actually quite wonderful. As the locals again defied the over-the-top police force and brought only peace, even though authorities tried to lock them in cages. [...] What will stop you? What will stop you? Nothing. **Nothing will stop us until, until, because it's our children. But when you say, oh yeah, your kids don't matter then, of course they matter. Until they're safe, until the people that are unvetted are taken away.** Once they're vetted, come back..... **They did too much to support Antifa on the first night and they didn't protect us from them at all. I'm really hoping this is to protect us from what they anticipated was coming from the left.** I'm really hoping that's what it's about. I can't actually imagine there are this many police to police a load of mums and dads walking to their local office. [...]"	Political rivals act against the interests of the people	**G:** Our borders are strained and/or insufficiently controlled **L:** Immigration is a threat to individual safety
Failure to Detect Counter-Narratives (10%). The model fails to recognise that a narrative is being rejected, or corrected, and instead classifies the transcript as expressing that narrative.	" Since the government's policy of sending asylum seekers to Rwanda came into effect, I've noticed a lot of discussion about the supposed link between illegal migration and Britain's social housing shortage. But that link isn't quite as straightforward as some people would like to make it out to be. It's true that in England there are currently over 1 million households waiting for social housing, but so far in 2024 around 8,200 people have arrived illegally in Britain via small boats crossing the English Channel. **They are not responsible for that enormous social housing waiting list.** And in fact, if you look at the government's own data, 90% of all social housing lead tenants, that's the person whose name will be on the lease, are British. **So it's simply not true that all of our social housing is going to illegal migrants** [...]"	None	**G:** Immigrants are a strain on the housing market **L:** Immigrants are a strain on the housing market
Weak Narrative Signal (5%). The transcript does not clearly express a strong narrative (often labelled as None), but the model predicts a narrative label based on weak topical cues or repeated keywords.	"[...] **They're going to start using TikTok influencers from Albania, Iraq, and Egypt and Iran. [...] There's been a million pounds set aside for this advertising campaign to get these influencers to encourage people to not try to cross over into the UK.** [...] **They're trying to tell people, look, there's nothing for you there... Don't go across the channel. It's very dangerous. You might drown. Whatever they're saying. And even when you get here, do you really want to join a machete drug gang?** [...] Because, of course, when people get here, they don't want to turn around and be like, oh, I made a terrible mistake. So they post all the pictures of themselves in the hotel rooms. Like we all do on Facebook. With the £10 notes. How great our life is going."	None	**G:** Immigrants are victims of false hope **L:** Immigrants are victims of false hope

Table 4: Error types and representative examples. Bold denotes our interpretation of the **gold-label rationale**, and red denotes our interpretation of the model's predicted-label rationale. Both bold and red indicate the **rationale for the multi-narrative overlap**. Percentages are the frequency of each error type for both Llama (L) and Gemma (G).

after task-specific fine-tuning.

5 Error Analysis

To better understand model limitations beyond overall performance, we conducted a qualitative error analysis on the **MigrationNarrate** development set, focusing on examples where both the top-performing open-source models, i.e., fine-tuned Llama and Gemma, misclassified the narrative label. In total, we manually inspected **60 video transcripts**, their gold labels, and the predictions from both models. In examining the sources of errors, we grouped them into 5 recurring error types presented in Table 4. These error types highlight both model limitations and the inherent complexities present in the labelled data.

Our analysis reveals systematic patterns underlying these errors. For instance, in *Surface-Narrative Misalignment* cases, models tend to prioritise salient lexical cues over the dominant narrative framing. In Table 4, row 1, the models predicted *"There are too many immigrants coming"* or *"Our borders are strained and/or insufficiently controlled"* based on explicit cues such as "`a record 973 illegal migrants entered Britain on 17 boats.`" and "`That is the biggest number this year`". However, the dominant narrative is *"Political rivals' policy failed/ is failing/ will fail"*, as the video primarily emphasises that Labour's plan to stop illegal immigrants is failing. *Fine-Grained Label Confusion* frequently arises in cases involving subtle differences in framing within the same narrative domain. For example, *Receiving immigrants is too expensive/ immigration burdens tax payers* and *Natives loose to immigrants/ Immigrants receive better benefits than nationals* are highly related and often overlap semantically. As shown in Table 4, row 2, although the primary focus

is the financial burden on British taxpayers, both models incorrectly predicted the latter narrative because the video also mentions the free benefits provided to the migrants. *Multi-Narrative Overlap* reflects inherent ambiguity in the data, where multiple interpretations are plausible (Table 4, row 3). Similarly, failures to detect counter-narratives indicate difficulty in capturing stance and negation, particularly in argumentative or conversational contexts (Table 4, row 4). Finally, weak narrative signal cases reveal a tendency to over-predict narratives even in the absence of strong evidence. For instance, in Table 4, row 5, although the gold label is *None*, both models predicted *Immigrants are victims of false hope* likely due to references to misleading portrayals of life in the UK on social media and unrealistic expectations.

In addition to the qualitative analysis, Figure 3 in Appendix L presents normalised confusion matrices for the two best-performing models on the development set at the super-narrative level. These matrices show label-level errors and confusion patterns across super-narratives.

Overall, our findings reveal that improving narrative detection requires addressing reliance on surface cues and difficulty capturing implicit framing. *Fine-Grained Label Confusion* and *Multi-Narrative Overlap* highlight ambiguity, suggesting the need for clearer label boundaries in narrative taxonomies, as well as support for multi-label annotation.

6 Conclusion

In this paper, we presented **MigrationNarrate**, the first dataset for detecting migration narratives in video transcripts. The dataset fills a critical research gap and provides a foundation for building tools for migration narrative detection. Additionally, we provided benchmark results by experimenting with a combination of pre-trained encoder models and both open- and closed-source LLMs. The results showed that fine-tuning open-source LLMs can outperform closed-source LLMs in zero-shot and few-shot settings at the super-narrative level; however, closed-source LLMs can still surpass them in fine-grained narrative detection. Finally, we conducted a thorough error analysis offering insights for future research directions.

Limitations

Manual selection of YouTube channels and search phrases Our data collection process relies on manually curated YouTube channels, playlists, and search phrases constructed based on the predefined super-narratives in the adopted JRC taxonomy. While this enables targeted retrieval of relevant content, it introduces potential selection bias and limits the representativeness of the dataset. In particular, super-narrative-driven query design may bias the data toward expected narrative frames, while channel- and playlist-level curation may further amplify certain viewpoints and filter out others.

Inter-annotator agreement The dataset was annotated with only two annotators per item, drawn from a pool of six, with disagreements resolved by an expert adjudicator. Inter-annotator agreement is relatively low, reflecting the difficulty of the task and matching similar studies for narrative detection. In particular, the large number of narratives, the presence of overlapping narratives in some videos, and the requirement for annotators to assign a single dominant narrative increase task difficulty, leading to ambiguity and potential label noise. Future work will further examine ambiguous labels through targeted re-annotation with three annotators per item and per-label agreement analysis, with the aim of identifying a high-confidence subset for benchmarking.

Dataset size and label sparsity The dataset is relatively small given the 53 fine-grained narrative labels, resulting in limited training examples for some classes. This may affect model performance and generalisability, particularly for less frequent narratives. Future work will extend **MigrationNarrate** with additional annotated examples to improve label coverage and support more robust modelling.

Absence of multimodal analysis Our approach is restricted to textual transcripts and does not account for video, audio, or other multimodal signals. This is a notable limitation, as narratives on YouTube are often conveyed through the interaction of visual, auditory, and textual elements. Consequently, our analysis may capture only a partial view of the underlying narratives. Future work will explore multimodal approaches that combine transcripts with visual and audio representations and assess how these additional modalities affect classification performance and error patterns.

Ethics Statement

Ethics Review Board The data collection and annotation tasks were approved by the University

Research and Ethics Committee.[9]

Annotator Consent and Compensation We followed university research ethics guidelines and informed annotators of potential risks associated with the task, including exposure to sensitive or potentially harmful content. Annotators were given time to review the task details and consent form before participation and were informed that they could opt out at any point. The consent form is provided in Appendix K. Annotators were compensated at an hourly rate equivalent to that of Graduate Teaching Assistants, in line with university guidelines.

YouTube Terms and Copyright The dataset is constructed from publicly available YouTube content in accordance with the platform's Terms of Service.[10] We do not redistribute audio, video, or transcripts. Instead, we provide only video identifiers and annotations, allowing the original content to be accessed through YouTube. We also release the code used to generate video transcripts for reproducibility. The dataset is intended for research use only and will be released under a CC-BY-NC-SA 4.0 license.

Privacy and Reputational Considerations The dataset is derived from publicly available YouTube content and does not include private or sensitive personal information. We restrict our study to textual transcripts and do not release audio or video data to reduce potential exposure of sensitive content. We also acknowledge a potential risk of reputational harm, as the dataset involves narratives that may be sensitive. However, our annotations focus on identifying narrative categories rather than evaluating the intent or credibility of individual speakers. Therefore, the dataset should not be interpreted as making claims about specific individuals.

Acknowledgements

This work was co-funded by the UK's innovation agency, Innovate UK, under grant number 10039039 (approved under the Horizon Europe Programme as VIGILANT, EU Grant Agreement No. 101073921), and the European Union's Horizon Europe research and innovation programme under the ANTIGONE project (EU Grant Agreement No. 101287848).

[9] https://sheffield.ac.uk/rpi/ethics-integrity

[10] https://www.youtube.com/static?template=terms

References

Lin Ai, Sameer Gupta, Shreya Oak, Zheng Hui, Zizhou Liu, and Julia Hirschberg. 2024. TweetIntent@Crisis: A Dataset Revealing Narratives of Both Sides in the Russia-Ukraine Crisis. In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media*, volume 18, pages 1872–1887.

Junfan Chen, Richong Zhang, Junchi Chen, and Chunming Hu. 2024. Open-set semi-supervised text classification via adversarial disagreement maximization. In *Proceedings of the 62nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, pages 2170–2180.

Travis G Coan, Constantine Boussalis, John Cook, and Mirjam O Nanko. 2021. Computer-assisted classification of contrarian claims about climate change. *Scientific Reports*, 11(1):22320.

Jacob Cohen. 1960. A coefficient of agreement for nominal scales. *Educational and psychological measurement*, 20(1):37–46.

James Dennison. 2021. Narratives: a review of concepts, determinants, effects, and uses in migration research. *Comparative Migration Studies*, 9(1):50.

Tim Dettmers, Artidoro Pagnoni, Ari Holtzman, and Luke Zettlemoyer. 2023. QLoRA: Efficient finetuning of quantized LLMs. *Advances in neural information processing systems*, 36:10088–10115.

Mark Dingemanse and Andreas Liesenfeld. 2022. From text to talk: Harnessing conversational corpora for humane and diversity-aware language technology. In *Proceedings of the 60th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, pages 5614–5633, Dublin, Ireland. Association for Computational Linguistics.

Ebubekir Düzcan. 2025. "Welcome to our channel and home": the mediatization of Turkish family history through family YouTube channels. *The History of the Family*, pages 1–27.

Jesús M Fraile-Hernández, Anselmo Peñas, and Pablo Moral. 2024. Automatic identification of narratives: Evaluation framework, annotation methodology and dataset creation. *IEEE Access*.

Blanca Garcés-Mascareñas and Ferruccio Pastore. 2025. The making of migration narratives: understanding processes and gauging impacts. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, 51(16):4119–4137.

Vahid Ghafouri, Robert McNeil, Teodor Yankov, Madeleine Sumption, Luc Rocher, Scott A Hale, and Adam Mahdi. 2025. Framing migration: A computational analysis of UK parliamentary discourse. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2509.14197*.

Aaron Grattafiori, Abhimanyu Dubey, Abhinav Jauhri, Abhinav Pandey, Abhishek Kadian, Ahmad Al-Dahle, Aiesha Letman, Akhil Mathur, Alan Schelten,

Alex Vaughan, et al. 2024. The Llama 3 Herd of Models.

Nuno Guimarães, Purificação Silvano, Ricardo Campos, Alipio Jorge, Ana Filipa Pacheco, Dimitar Iliyanov Dimitrov, Nikolaos Nikolaidis, Roman Yangarber, Elisa Sartori, Nicolas Stefanovitch, Preslav Nakov, Jakub Piskorski, and Giovanni Da San Martino. 2025. NarratEX dataset: Explaining the dominant narratives in news texts. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2025*, pages 20408–20434, Suzhou, China. Association for Computational Linguistics.

Fatima Haouari, Carolina Scarton, Nicolo Faggiani, Nikolaos Nikolaidis, Bonka Kotseva, Ibrahim Abu Farha, Jens Linge, and Kalina Bontcheva. 2025. UKElectionNarratives: A Dataset of Misleading Narratives Surrounding Recent UK General Elections. In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media*, volume 19, pages 2477–2495.

Philipp Heinrich, Andreas Blombach, Bao Minh Doan Dang, Leonardo Zilio, Linda Havenstein, Nathan Dykes, Stephanie Evert, and Fabian Schäfer. 2024. Automatic identification of COVID-19-related conspiracy narratives in German telegram channels and chats. In *Proceedings of the 2024 Joint International Conference on Computational Linguistics, Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC-COLING 2024)*.

Aaron Hurst, Adam Lerer, Adam P Goucher, Adam Perelman, Aditya Ramesh, Aidan Clark, AJ Ostrow, Akila Welihinda, Alan Hayes, Alec Radford, et al. 2024. GPT-4o system card. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.21276*.

Aishwarya Kamath, Johan Ferret, Shreya Pathak, Nino Vieillard, Ramona Merhej, Sarah Perrin, Tatiana Matejovicova, Alexandre Ramé, Morgane Rivière, Louis Rouillard, Thomas Mesnard, Geoffrey Cideron, et al. 2025. Gemma 3 technical report.

Bonka Kotseva, Irene Vianini, Nikolaos Nikolaidis, Nicolò Faggiani, Kristina Potapova, Caroline Gasparro, Yaniv Steiner, Jessica Scornavacche, Guillaume Jacquet, Vlad Dragu, et al. 2023. Trend analysis of COVID-19 mis/disinformation narratives–a 3-year study. *PLOS One*, 18(11):e0291423.

Yinhan Liu, Myle Ott, Naman Goyal, Jingfei Du, Mandar Joshi, Danqi Chen, Omer Levy, Mike Lewis, Luke Zettlemoyer, and Veselin Stoyanov. 2019. RoBERTa: A robustly optimized BERT pretraining approach. *arXiv preprint arXiv:1907.11692*.

Abdurahman Maarouf, Dominik Bär, Dominique Geissler, and Stefan Feuerriegel. 2024. HQP: A human-annotated dataset for detecting online propaganda. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2024*, pages 6064–6089, Bangkok, Thailand. Association for Computational Linguistics.

Marcello Maneri et al. 2023. A comparative analysis of migration narratives in traditional and social media. *Bridges*, pages 1–84.

Nikolaos Nikolaidis, Nicolas Stefanovitch, Purificação Silvano, Dimitar Iliyanov Dimitrov, Roman Yangarber, Nuno Guimarães, Elisa Sartori, Ion Androutsopoulos, Preslav Nakov, Giovanni Da San Martino, et al. 2025. PolyNarrative: A Multilingual, Multilabel, Multi-domain Dataset for Narrative Extraction from News Articles. In *Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, pages 31323–31345.

OpenAI. 2026. Introducing GPT-5.4. https://openai.com/index/introducing-gpt-5-4/. Accessed: 2026-04-26.

Jakub Piskorski, Tarek Mahmoud, Nikolaos Nikolaidis, Ricardo Campos, Alipio Mario Jorge, Dimitar Dimitrov, Purificação Silvano, Roman Yangarber, Shivam Sharma, Tanmoy Chakraborty, Nuno Guimaraes, Elisa Sartori, Nicolas Stefanovitch, Zhuohan Xie, Preslav Nakov, and Giovanni Da San Martino. 2025. SemEval 2025 task 10: Multilingual characterization and extraction of narratives from online news. In *Proceedings of the 19th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation (SemEval-2025)*, pages 2610–2643, Vienna, Austria. Association for Computational Linguistics.

Jakub Piskorski, Nikolaos Nikolaidis, Nicolas Stefanovitch, Bonka Kotseva, Irene Vianini, Sopho Kharazi, Jens P Linge, et al. 2022. Exploring data augmentation for classification of climate change denial: Preliminary study. In *Text2Story@ ECIR*, pages 97–109.

Alec Radford, Jong Wook Kim, Tao Xu, Greg Brockman, Christine McLeavey, and Ilya Sutskever. 2023. Robust speech recognition via large-scale weak supervision. In *Proceedings of the 40th International Conference on Machine Learning*, pages 28492–28518.

Resourcera. 2026. YouTube Statistics 2026: Users, Usage, and Key Metrics. https://resourcera.com/data/social/youtube-statistics/. Accessed: April 15, 2026.

Harri Rowlands, Gaku Morio, Dylan Tanner, and Christopher Manning. 2024. Predicting Narratives of Climate Obstruction in Social Media Advertising. In *ACL 2024*.

Zeynep Şahin-Mencütek. 2020. Migration Narratives in Policy and Politics. *Ryerson Centre for Migration and Settlement: Working Papers*.

Muhammad Umar Salman, Asif Hanif, Shady Shehata, and Preslav Nakov. 2023. Detecting propaganda techniques in code-switched social media text. In *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, pages 16794–16812, Singapore. Association for Computational Linguistics.

Konstantinos Sechidis, Grigorios Tsoumakas, and Ioannis Vlahavas. 2011. On the stratification of multi-label data. In *ECML PKDD 2011*.

Fiona Seiger, Nina Kajander, Alberto-Horst Neidhardt, Mario Scharfbillig, Lenka Dražanová, Christoph Deuster, Michal Krawczyk, Andrea Blasco, Rossella Icardi, Marina Tzvetkova, Lieke Bakker, and Karelis Olivo Rumpf. 2025. Navigating migration narratives. Technical Report KJ-01-25-336-EN-N (online),KJ-01-25-336-EN-C (print), Luxembourg (Luxembourg).

Aaditya Singh, Adam Fry, Adam Perelman, Adam Tart, Adi Ganesh, Ahmed El-Kishky, Aidan McLaughlin, Aiden Low, AJ Ostrow, Akhila Ananthram, et al. 2025a. OpenAI GPT-5 system card. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2601.03267*.

Iknoor Singh, Carolina Scarton, and Kalina Bontcheva. 2025b. GateNLP at Semeval-2025 task 10: Hierarchical three-step prompting for multilingual narrative classification. In *Proceedings of the 19th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation (SemEval-2025)*, pages 148–154.

Saskia Smellie and Christina Boswell. 2025. The influence of media narratives on political debate: narratives on the 2015 migrant 'crisis' in five European countries. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, 51(16):4181–4200.

Liang Wang, Nan Yang, Xiaolong Huang, Binxing Jiao, Linjun Yang, Daxin Jiang, Rangan Majumder, and Furu Wei. 2022. Text embeddings by weakly-supervised contrastive pre-training. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2212.03533*.

David Wilby, Twin Karmakharm, Ian Roberts, Xingyi Song, and Kalina Bontcheva. 2023. GATE teamware 2: An open-source tool for collaborative document classification annotation. In *Proceedings of the 17th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: System Demonstrations*, pages 145–151, Dubrovnik, Croatia. Association for Computational Linguistics.

An Yang, Baosong Yang, Beichen Zhang, Binyuan Hui, Bo Zheng, Bowen Yu, Chengyuan Li, Dayiheng Liu, et al. 2025a. Qwen2.5 technical report.

Weiyi Yang, Richong Zhang, Junfan Chen, and Jiawei Sheng. 2025b. Calibrating pseudo-labeling with class distribution for semi-supervised text classification. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, pages 13026–13039.

A Narrative Definitions

In this section, we present the narrative definitions used in our annotation guidelines and in our experiments. For readability, each narrative definition is presented using the format **super-narrative/narrative: narrative definition**, allowing readers to easily identify the corresponding super-narrative. Additionally, we present our prompt to GPT-5.1 to get the initial versions of our narrative definitions before manually reviewing them.

Narrative Definitions Prompt

You are a narrative-taxonomy assistant. Your task is to write clear, concise, and non-overlapping definitions for narratives that belong to a broader immigration super-narrative.

Inputs:

- Super-narrative: `<super-narrative>`
- Super-narrative definition: `<super-narrative definition>`
- List of narratives: `<comma-separated list of narratives>`

Instructions:

1. For each narrative, write 1–3 sentences defining it.
2. Definitions must fit logically under the super-narrative but be conceptually distinct.
3. Describe what each narrative claims without expressing personal, ethical, or political judgments.

Output format:

```
{
  "super_narrative": "<super-narrative>",
  "narrative_definitions": {
    "<narrative_1>": "<definition>",
    "<narrative_2>": "<definition>"
    .....
  }
}
```

1. **Immigrants' identity and/or culture is problematic/Immigration is a threat to the European way of life / identity:** This narrative claims that immigration introduces cultural changes that weaken or replace long-standing European customs, values, and collective identity. It asserts that demographic and cultural shifts driven by immigration risk undermining a cohesive and historically rooted European social fabric.

2. **Immigrants' identity and/or culture is problematic/Arabs and/or Muslims are a cultural/social threat:** This narrative portrays Arabs and/or Muslims as holding cultural or religious practices that are fundamentally incompatible with European norms and values. It suggests that their presence disrupts social cohesion and challenges culturally accepted ways of life associated with European societies.

3. **Immigrants' identity and/or culture is problematic/Certain immigrants are unwilling/incapable to integrate:** This narrative

argues that some immigrants do not adopt the host society's language, values, and cultural expectations, or are inherently unable to do so. It interprets continued cultural distinctions as evidence that meaningful integration into European societies is unlikely to occur for these groups.

4. **Immigration is a threat/Immigration is a threat to individual safety:** This narrative claims that the presence of immigrants increases risks to the physical safety and daily security of individuals. It suggests that ordinary citizens become more vulnerable to harm due to immigration.

5. **Immigration is a threat/Immigration is a threat to national security:** This narrative asserts that immigration undermines the safety and stability of the state by allowing potentially dangerous individuals or groups to enter the country. It frames immigration as a vulnerability that can be exploited to compromise national defence and security systems.

6. **Immigration is a threat/Immigrants are prone to committing crimes (violent, non-violent, or organised):** This narrative portrays immigrants as more likely than non-immigrants to engage in criminal activity, whether petty, violent, or organised crime. It claims that immigration increases crime rates and strains law enforcement systems.

7. **Immigration is a threat/Immigrants are prone to committing crimes of a sexual nature:** This narrative alleges that immigrant men, in particular, are more likely to commit sexual harassment, assault, or rape. It characterises immigration as heightening risks of sexually motivated harm to women and children.

8. **Immigration is a threat/Many immigrants are terrorists:** This narrative claims that immigration allows terrorists or radicalised individuals to enter the country and conduct attacks. It suggests that immigration is a direct pathway for extremist violence and instability.

9. **Immigration is a threat/Immigrants spread diseases:** This narrative asserts that immigrants are carriers of infectious diseases that pose health risks to the native population. It frames immigration as a public health threat capable of triggering outbreaks or overwhelming healthcare systems.

10. **Immigration is out of control/There are too many immigrants coming:** This narrative claims that the volume of arriving immigrants exceeds what the country can manage socially, economically, or culturally. It suggests that the pace and scale of immigration are unsustainable and create a perception of overwhelming influx.

11. **Immigration is out of control/Our borders are strained and/or insufficiently controlled:** This narrative asserts that border management systems are weak, unable to regulate who enters the country, or incapable of preventing irregular migration. It frames borders as overwhelmed or poorly enforced, implying that immigration is occurring without adequate oversight or restriction.

12. **Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative/Immigrants do not contribute to the economy:** This narrative claims that immigrants add little or no value to the host economy. It suggests that they rely on public resources without generating sufficient tax revenue or economic growth in return.

13. **Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative/Immigrants take our jobs:** This narrative asserts that immigrants compete directly with native citizens for employment opportunities. It suggests that immigration reduces job availability or lowers wages for the native workforce.

14. **Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative/Many asylum seekers are actually economic migrants:** This narrative claims that a significant number of asylum seekers are motivated primarily by financial gain rather than persecution. It portrays asylum claims as a strategic route to access economic benefits in the host country.

15. **Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative/Natives loose to immigrants / Immigrants receive better benefits than nationals:** This narrative alleges that immigrants receive more favourable access to welfare, housing, employment, or social services

than native-born citizens. It claims that natives are disadvantaged or deprioritised as a result.

16. **Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative/Immigrants abuse the welfare system:** This narrative portrays immigrants as intentionally exploiting welfare programmes to receive financial support without legitimate need. It suggests that welfare systems are manipulated or misused through fraud or opportunistic behaviour.

17. **Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative/Immigrants are a strain on our health-care system:** This narrative claims that immigration increases pressure on healthcare services, making it harder for native citizens to access timely and affordable medical care. It frames immigrants as consuming resources beyond the system's capacity.

18. **Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative/Immigrants are a strain on the housing market:** This narrative asserts that immigration contributes to housing shortages, rising rents, or limited access to affordable accommodation for native residents. It suggests that increased demand caused by immigration intensifies competition for housing.

19. **Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative/Natives first:** This narrative claims that economic resources, welfare services, and public support should prioritise native-born citizens over immigrants. It promotes the idea that natives are entitled to preferential treatment due to their status or historical connection to the nation.

20. **Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative/Immigration reduces the attractiveness of location and lowers overall life quality:** This narrative suggests that immigration negatively affects local communities by reducing standards of living, safety, or neighbourhood desirability. It implies that immigration leads to declining quality of public services, infrastructure, or community well-being.

21. **Immigration burdens the economy & welfare narrative/Receiving immigrants is too expensive/immigration burdens tax payers:** This narrative asserts that the financial costs of immigration—such as welfare, public services, integration programmes, and housing—place an excessive burden on taxpayers. It frames immigration as economically unsustainable due to the high level of public spending it requires.

22. **Immigrants are victims/Immigrants are victims of false hope:** This narrative claims that immigrants are misled into believing that life in Europe will guarantee security, prosperity, or opportunity, although these expectations are unlikely to be fulfilled. It presents migrants as suffering because they acted on unrealistic promises or inaccurate information about their prospects abroad.

23. **Immigrants are victims/Immigrants are victims of human traffickers:** This narrative asserts that migrants fall prey to criminal networks that exploit their vulnerability for profit. It claims that traffickers manipulate, coerce, or deceive immigrants, exposing them to dangerous travel routes, abuse, or exploitation.

24. **Immigrants are victims/EU/MS do not have the means to properly take care of immigrants, therefore it is better for them not to come here:** This narrative argues that European institutions or member states lack the capacity to provide adequate support, services, or protection to immigrants. It presents the inability to ensure proper living conditions as a reason why migrants ultimately suffer by coming.

25. **Immigrants are victims/Certain immigrants /asylum seekers are discriminated against:** This narrative claims that specific groups of immigrants or asylum seekers are subjected to unequal treatment due to their nationality, ethnicity, religion, or other characteristics. It frames institutional or social practices as systematically disadvantaging these migrants.

26. **Immigrants are victims/MS or EU are in breach of international law (e.g. inadequate reception facilities, refoulement at the borders, prolonged asylum procedures):** This narrative asserts that European institutions

or member states violate international or humanitarian law in their treatment of migrants. It highlights failures such as unlawful push-backs, substandard living conditions, or excessively long asylum procedures as evidence of wrongdoing.

27. **Immigrants are victims/Immigrants suffer from labour exploitation:** This narrative claims that immigrants experience unfair or abusive working conditions, including low wages, excessive hours, or unsafe environments. It presents migrants as vulnerable to economic exploitation due to their precarious legal or social position in the host country.

28. **Immigration is part of a conspiracy/Blaming global elites:** This narrative claims that powerful political, economic, or institutional actors deliberately promote or engineer migration flows for hidden strategic purposes. It suggests that immigration is not a natural social process but the result of a coordinated agenda imposed from above.

29. **Immigration is part of a conspiracy/Great replacement:** This narrative asserts that there is a deliberate plan to replace native European populations with non-European immigrants. It frames demographic change as intentional and directed, with the aim of eroding cultural, ethnic, or national identity.

30. **Immigration is part of a conspiracy/Other conspiracy theory:** This narrative applies conspiracy-based explanations to immigration beyond the ideas of global elite orchestration or population replacement. It claims that hidden actors or covert agendas are responsible for migration patterns, policies, or crises rather than social, economic, or geopolitical factors.

31. **Pragmatic approaches to immigration/Immigration helps tackle social & economic issues (e.g. skills and labour shortages):** This narrative claims that immigration provides practical benefits by filling critical gaps in the labour market, addressing demographic challenges, or supporting essential public services. It suggests that immigration can strengthen the host society when aligned with specific economic or social needs.

32. **Geopolitical narratives: Countries are acting against the interest of other countries/Immigration is abused as a political tool:** This narrative claims that governments or geopolitical actors intentionally manipulate migration flows to pressure, destabilise, or weaken other states. It portrays immigration policy and population movement as weapons used strategically in international competition rather than as neutral or humanitarian matters.

33. **Geopolitical narratives: Countries are acting against the interest of other countries/Our country is doing more than other countries to deal with immigration issues:** This narrative asserts that the home country carries a disproportionate burden in managing migration while other states fail to share responsibility or take adequate action. It frames the imbalance as strategically disadvantageous and suggests that the country is disadvantaged in the geopolitical landscape as a result.

34. **We are competent /Promoting policy initiatives or ideas:** This narrative claims that the political actor or party has concrete and effective proposals to address immigration challenges. It presents policy plans as practical solutions that will fix perceived problems and strengthen control over immigration.

35. **We are competent/Applauding political allies:** This narrative asserts that other domestic or international political actors who share similar views on immigration are capable and trustworthy partners. It highlights these alliances as evidence of strong leadership and as reinforcement of the party's credibility.

36. **We are competent/We represent the people:** This narrative claims that the political actor or party defends the interests and concerns of ordinary citizens regarding immigration. It positions the party as the only legitimate voice of the population against elites or institutions that allegedly ignore public demands.

37. **We are competent/We stand for common sense:** This narrative asserts that the party's immigration views reflect basic logic, practicality, and everyday reasoning. It implies that alternative migration approaches are irra-

tional or disconnected from the lived realities of ordinary people.

38. **We are competent/We will reinstate order:** This narrative claims that the political actor or party is capable of restoring control and stability in relation to immigration. It presents the party as able to correct mismanagement, curb chaos, and impose clear rules to ensure societal security and predictability.

39. **It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)/Discrediting liberal values:** This narrative claims that liberal ideals—such as multiculturalism, human rights, or open societies—are harmful to the nation and its people. It frames these values as imposed by the elite and opposed to the interests of ordinary citizens.

40. **It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)/EU is harmful for our nation:** This narrative asserts that the European Union undermines national interests by imposing regulations, policies, or migration rules that weaken the country. It portrays EU membership as limiting national autonomy and harming the well-being of citizens.

41. **It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)/Let's overthrow the establishment:** This narrative calls for the removal of the existing political leadership or governing institutions that are depicted as betraying public interests. It frames radical political change as necessary to regain control over national decision-making, especially regarding migration.

42. **It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)/Our sovereignty is under threat:** This narrative claims that national sovereignty is being eroded by international institutions, supranational actors, or global elites. It suggests that external forces dictate migration policies, preventing the nation from acting independently in the interests of its citizens.

43. **It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)/Discrediting political rivals (e.g. ridicule, accusation):** This narrative attacks political opponents by portraying them as incompetent, corrupt, foolish, or dishonest. It positions rivals as unfit to govern, especially in relation to migration, and emphasises their alleged failures or ulterior motives.

44. **It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)/Political rivals' policy failed/ is failing/ will fail:** This narrative claims that policies supported by political opponents have already failed, are currently failing, or are destined to fail. It highlights perceived negative outcomes of their migration policies as evidence that rivals cannot manage the issue effectively.

45. **It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)/Political rivals act against the interests of the people:** This narrative asserts that political opponents represent elites, foreigners, or special interest groups rather than ordinary citizens. It claims that rivals intentionally ignore or undermine the needs and concerns of the population regarding migration.

46. **It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)/Vindication:** This narrative claims that past warnings or predictions made by the populist party or leader about migration have proven correct. It presents unfolding events as confirmation that the party's position has always been accurate, reinforcing trust in its leadership.

47. **It is Us vs. Them (the establishment)/Anti-Elitism:** This narrative portrays elites—political, financial, academic, or media—as self-serving actors disconnected from ordinary people. It claims that the elite deliberately impose migration policies that harm the public while benefiting themselves or their networks.

48. **Narrative strategy to remain in the news/Reminder that immigration is an issue:** This narrative claims that immigration must remain a central topic of public concern and debate. It repeatedly emphasises that immigration is a pressing, unresolved, or urgent problem to ensure continuous media coverage and public attention.

49. **Narrative strategy to remain in the news/Self-promotion:** This narrative asserts that the political actor or party positions itself as highly relevant, visible, and central in discussions on immigration. It highlights their

role, actions, or statements as newsworthy to maintain prominence in the media landscape.

50. **There is an unfair bias against our political camp/We are being silenced:** This narrative claims that the political group is deliberately prevented from expressing its views on immigration or participating fully in public debate. It suggests that opponents or institutions actively suppress their opinions, visibility, or influence.

51. **There is an unfair bias against our political camp/Mainstream media are biased:** This narrative asserts that major media outlets consistently portray the political group negatively or downplay its arguments. It suggests that journalists and media organisations intentionally favour rival political actors and distort reporting on immigration.

52. **There is an unfair bias against our political camp/The judicial system favours political rivals and/or obstructs own political camp:** This narrative claims that courts, prosecutors, or legal institutions apply the law unevenly, shielding political opponents while targeting or hindering one's own political group. It describes legal decisions as part of a coordinated effort to disadvantage that group, especially on immigration matters.

53. **There is an unfair bias against our political camp/There are double-standards/ the system is corrupt:** This narrative asserts that political, legal, or institutional systems operate with biased rules that benefit rival groups and penalise one's own political camp. It frames corruption or partiality as intentional and systemic, reinforcing the idea of an unfair playing field.

B Videos Collection Source

In Table 5, we present the YouTube channels and playlists from which we collected our data.

C Videos Search Phrases

We present in Table 6 and Table 10, the general and narrative-oriented search phrases we used to search for videos respectively.

YouTube Channel	YouTube Playlist
@mwukofficial	All videos
@ReformUKOfficial	All videos
@labourparty	All videos
@Conservatives	All videos
@ukhomeoffice	All videos
@NigelFarageOfficial	All videos
@KeirStarmer	All videos
@TommyRobinsonOnline	All videos
@JimmyTheGiant	All videos
@Bigtastytompall	All videos
@NewCultureForum	All videos
@drmatthewgoodwin	All videos
@GBNewsOnline	Farage
@GBNewsOnline	Patrick Christys Tonight
@GBNewsOnline	Britain's Newsroom
@GBNewsOnline	Dewbs & Co
@BBCNews	UK
@BBCNews	Shorts
@SkyNews	Migration Crisis
@SkyNews	Politics 2025
@SkyNews	UK News 2025
@SkyNews	Migration Crisis
@SkyNews	UK News
@SkyNews	UK Riots
@SkyNews	Sky News Daily Podcasts
@SkyNews	The UK Tonight with Sarah-Jane Mee
@SkyNews	Strikes
@channel4news	UK News
@channel4news	UK Politics
@ITVNews	News Shorts
@gmb	Shorts
@gmb	Headlines
@talktv	News Shorts
@talktv	Shorts
@guardiannews	Headlines
@DailyExpress	UK News
@DailyExpress	UK Politics

Table 5: List of YouTube channels and corresponding playlists used for data collection.

D Semantic Filtering Queries

We present below the list of queries we adopted for filtering the videos semantically:

1. immigration in the UK
2. migration to the UK
3. migrants coming to or living in the UK
4. refugees in the UK
5. asylum seekers in the UK
6. Channel crossings and small boats coming to the UK
7. border control, deportations and visas in the UK
8. illegal immigration and people smuggling to the UK
9. government plans and deportation schemes for asylum seekers in the UK
10. UK immigration policy, laws and the migration bill

E Annotation Framework

We present in Figure 2, the annotation tool as presented to the annotators.

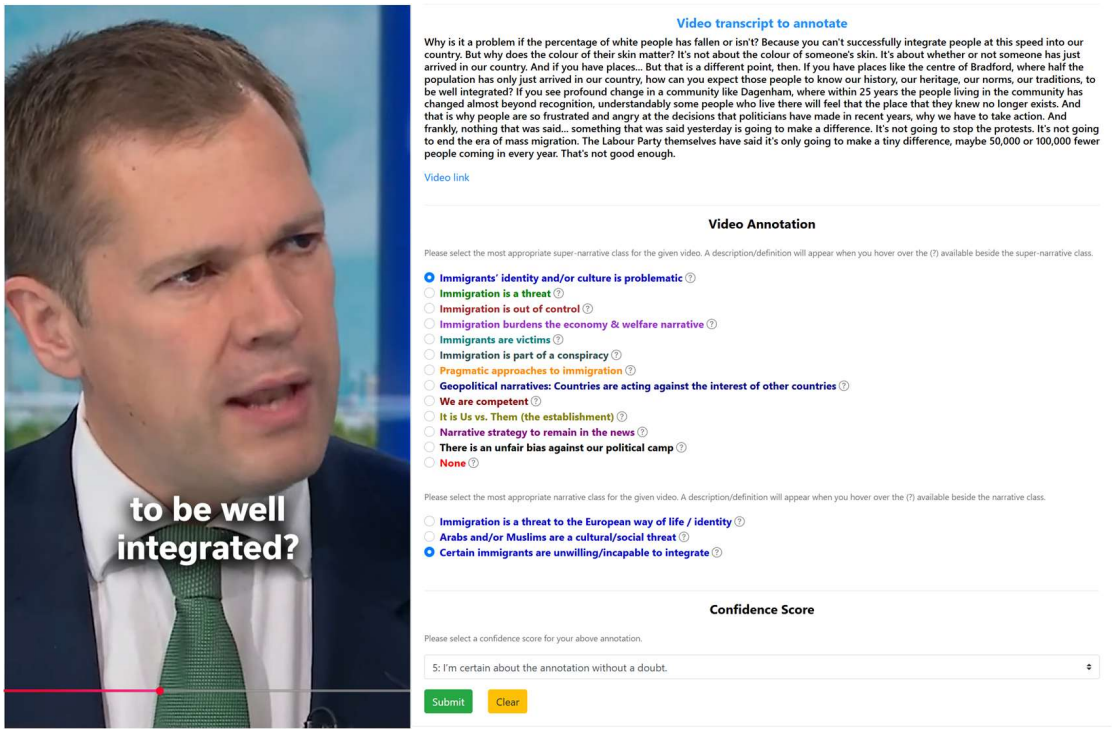


Figure 2: Annotation Framework. The annotator is shown the video transcript along with a direct link to the YouTube video. First, they are presented with the list of super-narratives only. Once a super-narrative is selected, the corresponding list of narratives is displayed. Label definitions are displayed when the annotator hovers over them.

Immigration UK
UK Immigration
Immigration in the UK
Migrants UK
UK migrant crisis
UK migration crisis
Illegal immigration UK
Asylum UK
UK asylum seekers
Refugees UK
Refugee crisis UK
Channel crossings UK
Small boats UK
Stop the boats UK
Border control UK

Table 6: General search phrases.

F Benchmarking prompt

LLMs Two-step Prompt (Step 1)

Classify the given video transcript into the most relevant migration super_narrative.

Super_narratives:
super_narrative 1: super_narrative 1 definition
super_narrative 2: super_narrative 2 definition
....
....
Examples:
Video transcript: {video transcript 1}
Super_narrative: {super_narrative 1}
Video transcript: {video transcript 2}
Super_narrative: {super_narrative 2}
....
....

Video transcript:

Return the most relevant super_narrative. If no super_narrative applies, return "None". Return only the super_narrative label without any additional explanation.

LLMs Two-step Prompt (Step 2)

The given video transcript is related to migration, and its main super_narrative is: {super_narrative}. Classify it into the most relevant narrative.

Narratives:
narrative 1: narrative 1 definition
narrative 2: narrative 2 definition
....
....
Examples:
Video transcript: {video transcript 1}
Narrative: {Narrative 1}
Video transcript: {video transcript 2}
Narrative: {Narrative 2}
....
....

Video transcript:

Return the most relevant narrative. If no narrative applies, return "None". Return only the narrative label without any additional explanation.

G MigrationNarrate Statistics

In Table 7, we present further stats about our full and labelled dataset.

Dataset	Total Videos	Unique Channels	Avg. Duration (Secs)
Full corpus	5,540	2,081	90.46
Human-annotated	1,115	684	79.73

Table 7: **MigrationNarrate** statistics.

H MigrationNarrate Examples

In Table 9, we present examples from **MigrationNarrate**.

I Hyperparameters Fine-tuning

We fine-tuned RoBERTa-large using standard supervised fine-tuning with a maximum sequence length of 512 tokens, batch size 16, and training for 5 epochs. We searched learning rates over {1e-5, 2e-5, 3e-5} and dropout values over $\{0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$. For the LLMs, we applied QLoRA (Dettmers et al., 2023), where LoRA adapters were applied to all linear layers with rank $r = 16$, $\alpha = 32$, and dropout values from $\{0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$. Models were trained for three epochs using learning rates from {1e-4, 2e-4, 3e-4}, with batch size 1 and gradient accumulation of 8 steps. For all models, hyperparameters were selected based on the best Macro-F1 score on the development set, and results are reported from a *single run*. We present the best hyperparameters selected for each model in Table 8.

Model	Learning Rate	Dropout
RoBERTa-large$_{\text{super_narrative}}$	2e-5	0.3
RoBERTa-large$_{\text{narrative}}$	3e-5	0.1
Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct	3e-4	0.2
Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct	3e-4	0.1
Gemma-3-12b-it	2e-4	0.1

Table 8: Best hyperparameter settings selected based on Macro-F1 score on the development set.

J Computational Resources

To perform our experiments, we used our internal servers using NVIDIA A100-PCIE-40GB GPUs.

K Annotator Consent Form

We present below the questions presented in the consent form given to the annotators. The annotators were asked to answer a list of questions by either YES or NO.

Taking Part in the Project

1. I have read and understood the project information sheet or the project has been fully explained to me. (If you will answer No to this question please do not proceed with this consent form until you are fully aware of what your participation in the project will mean.)

2. I am 18 years or older and a fluent speaker of English

3. I have been given the opportunity to ask questions about the project.

4. I agree to take part in the project. I understand that taking part in the project will include annotating content that might be triggering.

5. I understand that I can withdraw from the study at any time; I do not have to give any reasons for why I no longer want to take part and there will be no adverse consequences if I choose to withdraw.

How my information will be used during and after the project

1. I understand my personal details such as name and email address etc. will not be revealed to people outside the project.

2. I understand that my personal details will not be stored, linked to my annotations or shared.

So that the information you provide can be used legally by the researchers

1. I agree to assign the copyright I hold in any materials generated as part of this project to the university.

2. I understand that the results from the annotations I provided will appear in scientific publications and white papers, without myself being identified or acknowledged, given the anonymised nature of the research.

Video transcript	Super-Narrative	Narrative
PM Starmer of UK getting pressure day by day. New pressure on PM Starmer and the pressure is that one more milestone of illegals are achieved. UK is breaking records even more than US regarding illegals. 33,000 boats reached in this year. 33,000 boats mean in each boat at least 100 people may be travelling. And how many people as illegals entered? You just calculate mathematically and this is an arithmetic fashion. Illegals are being increased and Stormer feeling severe pressure from all community. Thank you. Thank you very much.	Immigration is out of control	There are too many immigrants coming
We've got a demographic crisis where the data clearly shows the number of British-born children is declining. And that's one of the reasons why lots of people are sort of saying, oh, the globalists are saying we need more mass immigration into the UK because the population... Well, maybe if you had more British-born children, then that would be a good thing. Who believe in British values, grow up with British education and understanding and culture. And that way there's less pressure to bring in immigration from overseas. So I think it makes perfect sense. And, you know, there are three key themes, family, community and country. And strong, successful working families create strong communities. And if you've got strong communities, you've got a strong country. And that's who we are and that's what we're about. I just don't care about the labels. We just want to do what we think is right for the country.	Immigration is part of a conspiracy	Great replacement
Who are the human smugglers? In Britain, it's whoever people you are bringing in. Like if there's people coming in from Albania, them areas, it'll be Albanian gang. If they're coming from India, it's an Indian person that controls it. Right. The normal situation is 10 grand a pop and we bring you over in a container. I was talking to these people and they were saying, do you want to get involved in this, this, that, there's this money you made. They said, but what we really do is this, yeah? We get about 30 of them in a container, 10 grand a piece, we pop them off, take them to the sea, and they never get to the destination. So we don't actually do any work of taking them there. And they told you they were going to do this? This is what they do, yeah.	Immigrants are victims	Immigrants are victims of human traffickers
Migrant care workers in the UK are falling victim to exploitation, with some earning less than £5 an hour. Recent studies have shown that visa routes for both social and domestic workers foster conditions ripe for abuse, often leading to situations akin to modern slavery. Shocking findings include workers overstaying visas due to dire work conditions and paltry wages, with one individual on an overseas domestic worker visa receiving a mere £20 for their entire stay. Many cases reveal pay below the national minimum wage, inadequate accommodations with excessive rents, and constant surveillance. The government insists on taking action against such abusive practices. To understand the full extent of these issues and ongoing efforts, visit visaverge.com for comprehensive coverage.	Immigrants are victims	Immigrants suffer from labour exploitation

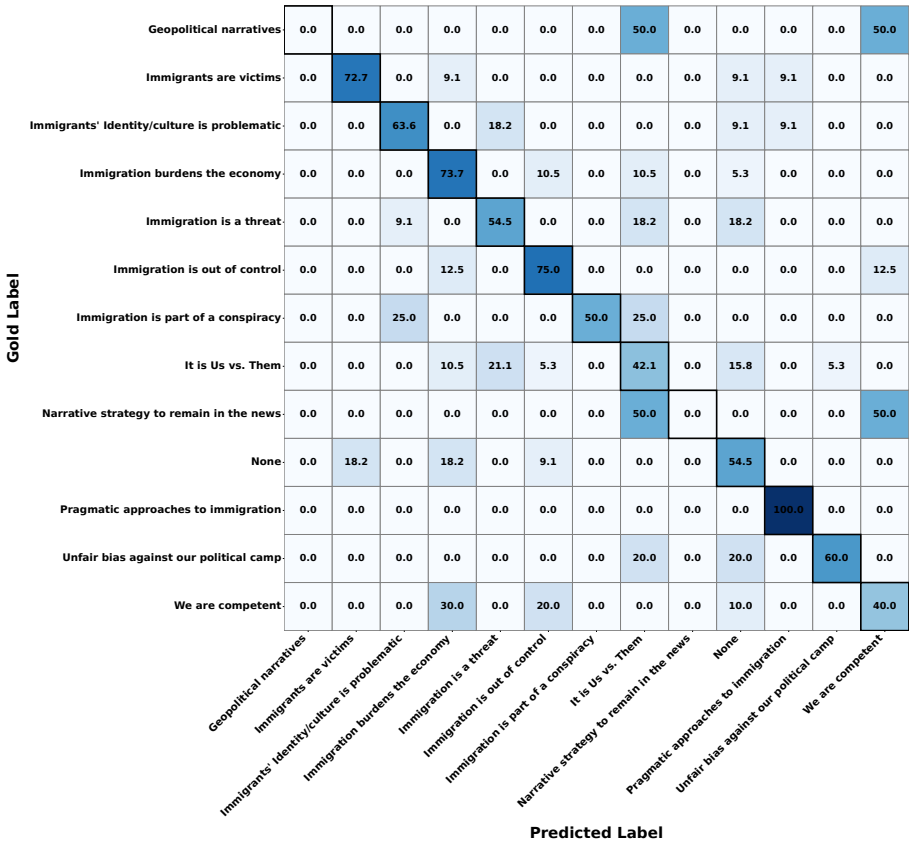
Table 9: Examples from **MigrationNarrate** dataset.

Muslim immigration UK
Islam immigration UK
British culture immigration
British identity immigration
Sharia law immigration UK
immigration out of control UK
immigration numbers too high UK
mass immigration UK
UK losing control of immigration
immigration getting worse UK
immigrant crime UK
migrant crime UK
asylum seeker crime UK
immigration and terrorism UK
immigration national security UK
immigrants taking jobs UK
immigration jobs UK
asylum seekers benefits UK
immigrants abusing welfare UK
immigration burden taxpayers UK
immigration burden NHS UK
immigration housing crisis UK
asylum hotel cost UK
immigration cost of living UK
immigrant exploitation UK
immigrants suffering UK
immigrants discrimination UK
migrants victims of trafficking UK
migrants victims of smugglers UK
immigration human rights UK
immigration great replacement UK
immigration conspiracy UK
immigration agenda UK
population replacement UK
UK demographic replacement
UK needs migrant workers
UK needs skilled immigration
immigration supports the NHS
immigration supports UK economy
migrant workers essential UK
immigration labour shortages UK
immigration crackdown working UK
immigration policy success UK
immigration numbers down UK
border control is working UK
restoring border control UK
taking back control immigration UK
immigration political tool UK
political pressure over immigration UK
immigration international politics UK
immigration foreign policy UK
UK doing more on immigration
government ignoring immigration UK
politicians ignoring immigration UK
media hiding immigration UK
elites pushing immigration UK
sovereignty under threat immigration UK
immigration is the real issue UK
immigration remains the main issue UK
media bias immigration UK
judicial bias immigration UK
system bias immigration UK

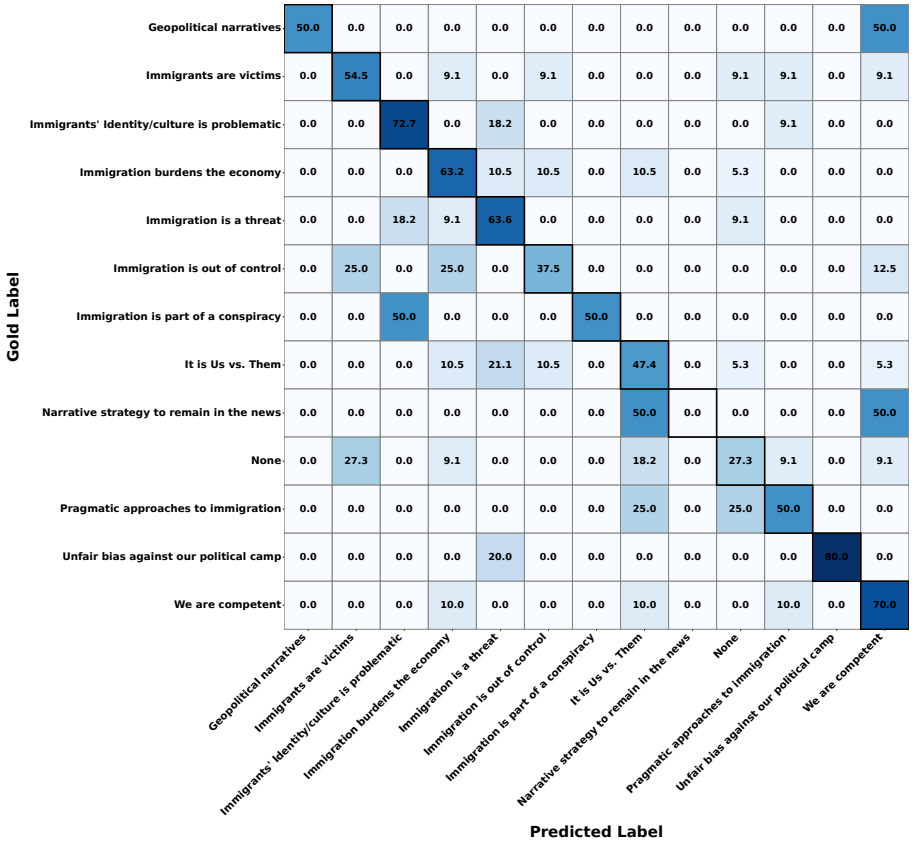
Table 10: Narrativeoriented search phrases.

L Quantitative Error Analysis

Figure 3 presents the confusion matrices for the two best-performing models on the development set at the super-narrative level, providing a quantitative view of label-level misclassification patterns.



(a) Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct (fine-tuned)



(b) Gemma-3-12B-it (fine-tuned)

Figure 3: Confusion matrices for the two best-performing models on the development set at the super-narrative level.